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|  | <b>Division/Section</b>  | Family Support                                                 |
|                                                                                  | <b>Chapter No./Name</b>  | 4 – Economic Stability (ES)                                    |
|                                                                                  | <b>Part No./Name</b>     | O – Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (DSNAP) |
|                                                                                  | <b>Section No./Name</b>  | O-200-DSNAP Implementation                                     |
|                                                                                  | <b>Document No./Name</b> | O-220-DSNAP Alternatives to DSNAP                              |
|                                                                                  | <b>Effective Date</b>    | January 1, 2010                                                |

The decision on whether to utilize the regular SNAP and/or commodity distribution programs instead of requesting FNS authorization of a DSNAP depends on the nature of the disaster.

### **O-221-DSNAP REGULAR SNAP VS. DSNAP**

Generally, the following factors suggest utilization of the regular SNAP:

- The affected population is fairly small.
- The affected population is mostly the residents that are already eligible for or would be eligible for regular SNAP benefits.
- The effects of the disaster appear to be fairly short-term.
- The regular SNAP is expected to be able to meet the needs of the affected population.

Generally, the following factors suggest implementation of a DSNAP:

- The affected population is large.
- The affected population includes a large number of residents that would not be eligible for regular SNAP benefits.
- Damage caused by the disaster is so severe or widespread that regular SNAP application procedures would be too cumbersome.
- The affected population needs the benefit of less strict DSNAP eligibility criteria and/or access to benefits more quickly than the regular SNAP could provide.
- The nature of the disaster is such that many households will not have the verification required by the regular SNAP.
- The increase in the demand for SNAP benefits is expected to be dramatic and unable to be handled by the regular SNAP.

### **O-222-DSNAP COMMODITY DISTRIBUTION PROGRAM VS. DSNAP**

In disaster situations, a DSNAP should not be implemented until commercial channels of food distribution are restored. In these situations, a commodity distribution program should be utilized as an interim measure until the commercial channels of food distribution become available. A DSNAP cannot be implemented while the disaster commodity distribution is occurring.

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|  <b>Department of<br/>Children &amp;<br/>Family Services</b><br><i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i> | <b>Division/Section</b>  | Family Support                                                 |
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Instead of a DSNAP, a commodity distribution program can also be utilized jointly with the regular SNAP in situations where the affected population is fairly small and isolated.